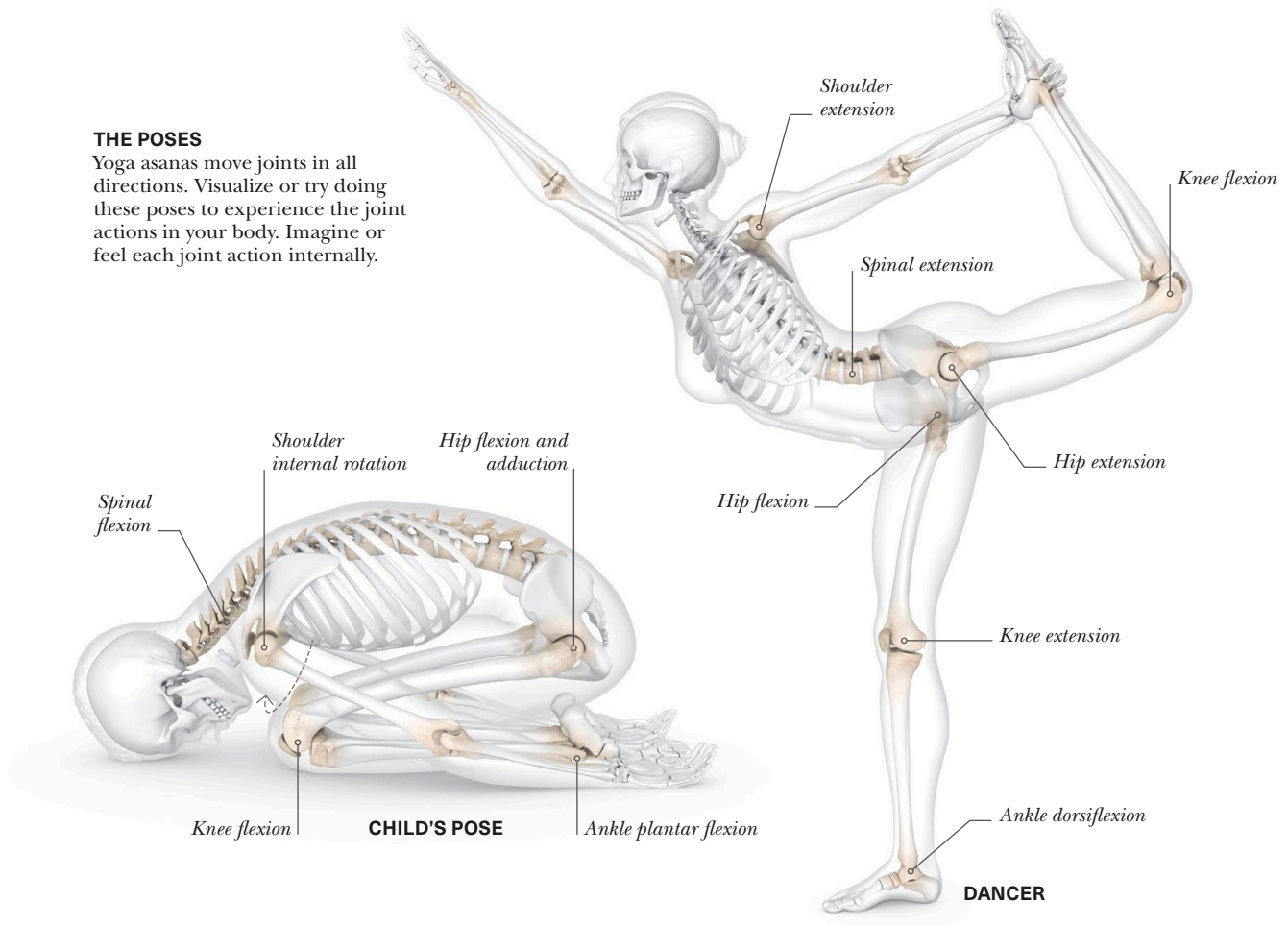


THE POSES

Yoga asanas move joints in all directions. Visualize or try doing these poses to experience the joint actions in your body. Imagine or feel each joint action internally.

**Arthritis**

Wear and tear on joints can lead to osteoarthritis. In a 7-year clinical trial, researchers found that yoga is safe and effective in managing both osteoarthritis and rheumatoid arthritis (see p.37). After an 8-week yoga class, participants showed a reduction in pain by 25 percent, along with statistically significant improvements in physical fitness and quality of life.

PROGRESSION

As cartilage degrades there is less space in the joint, leading to inflammation and pain. Bone spurs or osteophytes can form as the condition progresses.

